

CANONICAL LESSON

# Count Herds, Understand Systems

Decision-centred foundations for accountable sector intelligence

|                 |                                   |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------|
| Production Unit | PU-B07-C18                        |
| Notebook        | V7_A_N13                          |
| Status          | Controlled educational draft v0.1 |
| Data boundary   | Synthetic instructional data only |

**Central decision:** Analyse livestock by production system, mobility, species, ownership, season, and denominator rather than relying on undifferentiated animal counts.

## Learning outcomes

### Why this matters

Animal counts alone can conceal mobility, ownership concentration, production purpose, mortality, and seasonal availability.

The analytical workflow is useful only when evidence, uncertainty, authority, and action are connected explicitly. The model supports professional judgement; it does not replace accountable institutional authority.

### Worked cross-sector example

A livestock indicator distinguishes herd size from livestock-owning households and records transhumant mobility and reference season.

**Boundary:** The example supports learning and review. It does not constitute an official statistic, eligibility determination, enforcement action, clinical judgement, or operational authorization.

## Practice and reflection

- 1.
- Add seasonal mobility.
- 2.
- Distinguish animals from livestock units.
- 3.

- Explain the disease-control boundary.

## Answer key

- 1.
- Use route/season calendars and double-count controls agreed with pastoral communities.
- 2.
- Headcounts describe animals; livestock units standardize approximate resource demand using explicit factors.
- 3.
- Surveillance signals require veterinary confirmation, law, risk assessment, proportionality, communication, and compensation safeguards.

## Operational readiness checklist

- Purpose and decision owner are named.
- Evidence definitions, provenance, and lawful access are documented.
- Uncertainty and abstention are visible.
- Human review, escalation, monitoring, incident response, and retirement are assigned.
- Equity, accessibility, security, and sector-specific approval are complete.